

Mae Jemison

The Girl Who Made Room for a Big Dream

The true story of a girl who loved the stars and dancing, told her teacher she would be a scientist, and became the first Black woman to travel into space.

Before reading

Look at the cover. Where is little Mae pointing? Who do you think the astronaut is?

While reading

1. What did Mae say when her teacher asked, “Don’t you mean a nurse?”
2. What did Mae notice about the astronauts she saw on television?
3. Mae loved science *and* dance. Why didn’t she have to choose?

After reading

1. What do you dream of being or doing? Is it surprising?
2. Mae trained again and again with her crew. Who is on your team?
3. Mae took special things into space. What would you take?

The big idea

Dream big. Learn lots. Reach far.

Help your child name one big dream, one thing they can learn now, and one person who can help.

Try this together

A mission badge. Design a badge for your own space mission. What is your mission for? Who is in your crew? Draw everyone’s name around the edge.

Words to talk about

astronaut · space shuttle · scientist · doctor · crew · mission

Tips for reading aloud: pause on the pictures and let children notice details first. There are no wrong answers to these questions; follow your child’s curiosity. The back of the book has four simple experiments to try, and a free activity pack is at tarkasatales.com/activities.

© 2026 Saurabh Vig · Free for home & classroom use